

12-Week Strength Foundation

Prepared for Alex Doe

VERSION 3

APPROVED BY TRAINER

Sam Trainer ½ Iron Path Studio ½ NASM-CPT

August 11, 2026

12 weeks

DURATION

4

DAYS / WEEK

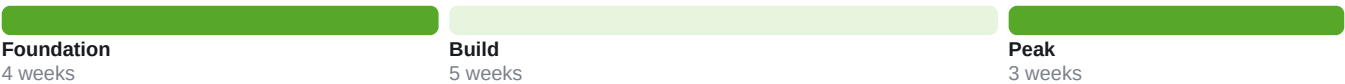
3

PHASES

96

TOTAL SETS

PROGRAMME TIMELINE



OVERVIEW

Plan summary

Primary goal	Build strength
Experience level	Intermediate
Session duration	60 min
Split	Upper/Lower
Equipment	Full gym
Key limitations	Left knee sensitivity
Exercises programmed	24

PHASE 1 12½ 4 WEEKS

Foundation

Build a resilient base of strength and movement quality.

PROGRESSION

RECOVERY

ADVANCE WHEN

Add load weekly while keeping RPE at 8.

Two full rest days, 7-8h sleep.

All sets completed at target RPE for two weeks.

WORKING SETS PER SESSION



Day 1 12½ Lower 12½ Lower body strength

60 min 12½ 16 sets

Warm-up: Bike 5 min 12½ Hip openers 12½ Banded walks

MAIN WORK

Barbell Back Squat

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Romanian Deadlift

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

ACCESSORY WORK

Split Squat

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Leg Curl

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Conditioning: Sled push 6x20m

Cool-down: Couch stretch 12½ Box breathing

Notes: Keep bar speed crisp.

Day 2 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Upper $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Lower body strength

60 min $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 16 sets

Warm-up: Bike 5 min $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Hip openers $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Banded walks

MAIN WORK

Barbell Back Squat

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Romanian Deadlift

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

ACCESSORY WORK

Split Squat

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Leg Curl

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Conditioning: Sled push 6x20m

Cool-down: Couch stretch $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Box breathing

Notes: Keep bar speed crisp.

PHASE 2 12½ 5 WEEKS

Build

Build a resilient base of strength and movement quality.

PROGRESSION

RECOVERY

ADVANCE WHEN

Add load weekly while keeping RPE at 8.

Two full rest days, 7-8h sleep.

All sets completed at target RPE for two weeks.

WORKING SETS PER SESSION



Day 1 12½ Lower 12½ Lower body strength

60 min 12½ 16 sets

Warm-up: Bike 5 min 12½ Hip openers 12½ Banded walks

MAIN WORK

Barbell Back Squat

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Romanian Deadlift

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

ACCESSORY WORK

Split Squat

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Leg Curl

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Conditioning: Sled push 6x20m

Cool-down: Couch stretch 12½ Box breathing

Notes: Keep bar speed crisp.

Day 2 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Upper $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Lower body strength

60 min $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 16 sets

Warm-up: Bike 5 min $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Hip openers $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Banded walks

MAIN WORK

Barbell Back Squat

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Romanian Deadlift

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

ACCESSORY WORK

Split Squat

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Leg Curl

4 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Conditioning: Sled push 6x20m

Cool-down: Couch stretch $\dot{\text{I}}\dot{\text{C}}\frac{1}{2}$ Box breathing

Notes: Keep bar speed crisp.

PHASE 3 12½ 3 WEEKS

Peak

Build a resilient base of strength and movement quality.

PROGRESSION

RECOVERY

ADVANCE WHEN

Add load weekly while keeping RPE at 8.

Two full rest days, 7-8h sleep.

All sets completed at target RPE for two weeks.

WORKING SETS PER SESSION



Day 1 12½ Lower 12½ Lower body strength

60 min 12½ 16 sets

Warm-up: Bike 5 min 12½ Hip openers 12½ Banded walks

MAIN WORK

Barbell Back Squat

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Romanian Deadlift

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

ACCESSORY WORK

Split Squat

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Leg Curl

4 12½ 8-10 12½ Rest 90s 12½ RPE 8 12½ Tempo 3-1-1

Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.

Easier: Goblet squat to box

Harder: Add 2.5kg per week

Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Conditioning: Sled push 6x20m

Cool-down: Couch stretch 12½ Box breathing

Notes: Keep bar speed crisp.

Day 2 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Upper $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Lower body strength

60 min $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ 16 sets

Warm-up: Bike 5 min $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Hip openers $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Banded walks

MAIN WORK

Barbell Back Squat

4 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Tempo 3-1-1
Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.
Easier: Goblet squat to box
Harder: Add 2.5kg per week
Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Romanian Deadlift

4 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Tempo 3-1-1
Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.
Easier: Goblet squat to box
Harder: Add 2.5kg per week
Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

ACCESSORY WORK

Split Squat

4 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Tempo 3-1-1
Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.
Easier: Goblet squat to box
Harder: Add 2.5kg per week
Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Leg Curl

4 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ 8-10 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Rest 90s $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ RPE 8 $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Tempo 3-1-1
Cue: Brace hard, ribs down, drive through mid-foot throughout the full range of motion.
Easier: Goblet squat to box
Harder: Add 2.5kg per week
Safety: Stop if knee pain exceeds 3/10.

Conditioning: Sled push 6x20m
Cool-down: Couch stretch $\dot{\text{L}}$ $\dot{\text{U}}$ Box breathing
Notes: Keep bar speed crisp.

TRACKING

Progress monitoring

Weekly progression	Add reps then load.
Load increases	2.5-5% when top set feels RPE 7.
Deloads	Week 6 and 11 at 60% volume.
Adjust if	Poor sleep or joint pain.
Reassessment	Week 12

COACHING

Programming notes

- Warm-ups are non negotiable.
- Log every set.

FOLLOW-UP

Information to confirm

- Confirm bodyweight
- Confirm knee history

FROM YOUR COACH

Trainer notes

Focus on tempo control during the first four weeks.

This plan is a professional planning document prepared by a certified trainer with AI assistance. It is not medical advice, diagnosis or treatment. Clients with health concerns should obtain medical clearance before starting.